

By Rabbi Dr. Shaul Schwalb



Somehow we are faced with a section of Torah that discusses the counting of the Jewish people and the necessity for "kaparah" or forgiveness. What are we being forgiven for? That is the million-dollar question. Rashi, our beloved teacher of the year 1075, tells us that a plague erupts when the Jewish people are counted directly. To save us from this plague, we use coins and as such prevent the plague. Seems like Rashi sees a mystical problem with counting Jews individually. Many mefarshim, including a Gmara Yerushalmi in Shekolim, explain that the sin is that of the golden calf and that is what the shekel is for. Yet why pay it while being counted? And why pay for only 20 yr olds and over while the entire nation sinned at the golden calf? Of course, why pay before the sin? Did this section at the beginning of our Parsha occur before or after the golden calf? There are many approaches here, including the preventive necessity of getting a Kaparah even BEFORE the sin! The Kli Yakar, a perush of the 1550's explains that the counting and the forgiveness, "kaparah" are tied together. He explains that after the sin of the golden calf, all of klal yisroel as a group, a nation, deserved punishment. G-d was dissuaded by Moshe, but only forgiveness given as a klal. The sheer magnitude of the numbers of klal yisroel. When each individual Jew is counted, he takes himself outside of the klal. There lies the issue here, the need for forgiveness is due to the fact that all were guilty of the golden calf but only klal yisroel forgiven, so take yourself out of klal yisroel and you will need special forgiveness, hence the half shekel! When we count an individual Jew, per head, we make him an individual separated from klal yisroel as a whole.



Legacy: The war led to the establishment of no-fly zones in Iraq and created tensions that ultimately led to the 2003 invasion.

By: Gabriella and Mikayla



1. Super Heavy Flyer
The Kori bustard is one of the heaviest birds that can still fly!
2. Balloon Neck Trick
Boys puff up their necks like a big balloon to impress the girls.
3. Bug & Snake Eater
They munch on insects, lizards, and even small snakes!



- **Year Formed:** 1836
 - **Capital:** Little Rock
 - **State Flower:** Apple Blossom
 - **State Bird:** Northern Mockingbird
 - **Population:** ~ 3.09
 - **State Motto:** "Regnat Populus," which is Latin for "The People Rule"
 - **Fun Fact:** "Arkansas" is derived from the Quapaw Indians and means "people who live downstream".
 - **Must-Visit Place:** Buffalo National River
- 



Weekly Q&A with Dr. Shari Hirsch,
Pediatrician and Lactation Specialist at Lev Pediatric Care

WEEK 12

"How can I better advocate for my child during doctor visits?"

The good news is that you don't need medical training to be a strong advocate. You already know your child best, and your voice matters.

Come prepared, but don't stress
You don't need anything fancy. A few notes on your phone can help, like when symptoms started, fevers, medications tried, and what's improving or getting worse. This helps your pediatrician get the full picture quickly.

Send it to Lev Pediatric Care, and Dr. Hirsch may feature it in an upcoming Q and A.

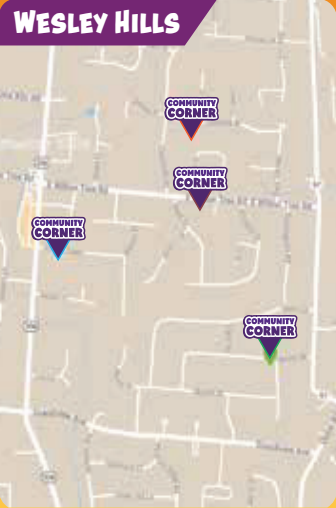
By: Chanalee-The Challah Fairy
917-414-9123

Beat above ingredients in your mixture separately

Roll out dough in between two pieces of parchment paper with flour sprinkled on both sides of dough to prevent sticking . Then cut into thin strips like in picture . Cut in half lengthwise. Shmear all the meringue topping on top. Roll each piece and place face up on cookie sheet. Bake at 325 for 15-20 minutes. When completely dry, powder with confectionery sugar. And yummmm !

Can you find all 8 differences?

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Kennis Snaar Hashamlayim of 71 East Willow Tree Rd (Moshe Drach)

RIBE
sletter!

A purple mailbox with a red flag is shown on a wooden post. A yellow envelope is partially inside the mailbox. To the left of the mailbox is a white paper airplane. The background is a solid yellow color.

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That's the best time for quick car thefts.**

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COMMUNITY CORNER

PARSHAS

KI SISA כִּי תִשָּׂא



SHABBOS STARTS: **5:34 PM**
(18 MINUTES)
Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern

SHABBOS ENDS: **6:35 PM**
(50 MINUTES)

TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM: **7:07 PM**
(72 MINUTES)

Made possible by contributing writers throughout our community.



STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz



In the winter of the year 1592, the Maharal of Prague, Rabbi Yehuda Lowe, was called to see Emperor Rudolph II. The famed Rabbi spent a long time with the Emperor, but no one knew what it was all about. Many years later, this story was told about the visit and a strange dream that the Emperor had. At the Emperor's court there were some ministers who were envious of the great respect and honor that the famed Maharal was enjoying. Both Jews and non-Jews knew that the Maharal was a holy man and they respected him greatly. The courtiers of the Emperor planned to drive the Rabbi out of Prague and send him and all his flock into exile. Knowing that the Emperor would not hear of such a thing, they turned to the Empress, who promised to induce the Emperor to carry out the plan.

In the evening, the Empress handed the papers containing the harsh decree to her husband and asked him to sign them at once. At first, the Emperor hesitated to sign the decree, but when his wife persisted in her request, he said that he would "sleep on it," and sign the papers in the morning.

That night, the Emperor had a strange dream...He was waging war, but was captured and placed in prison, where he was told he would spend the rest of his life. For many years the Emperor remained in prison, living on bread and water, with no one taking any interest in him.

One day an old Jew passed the prison. He was a venerable-looking man, with kindly eyes. The Emperor called out to him. The old man stopped and looked at the prisoner behind the bars.

"I am the Emperor," the prisoner exclaimed. "Don't you recognize me?"

"You have changed, Sire," the old man replied.

"I swear to you that I am the Emperor Rudolph. Please get me out of here," the prisoner begged desperately.

The old man knocked at the prison wall with his cane, and immediately there appeared a passage in the wall. The Emperor walked out and went with the old man to his home.

"You cannot return to the palace in this state," the old man told him, "for no one will recognize you. I will send for a barber and a tailor to groom you and to prepare royal robes for you. In the meantime, lie down and rest."

Then the old man placed two plates near the bed. "What are these for?" the puzzled Emperor asked.

"One is for your nails and the other for your hair," the old man replied.

"How can I ever thank you?" the Emperor asked, with tears of gratitude rolling down his cheeks.

The Emperor awoke and wiped the tears from his cheeks. He sat up in bed and saw two plates on a little table near his bed. His thoughts turned to his strange dream. "Only the saintly Rabbi, Rabbi Lowe, could explain to me the meaning of the dream," the Emperor thought. At that moment there was a knock at the door. "You ordered the Royal Barber to report this morning," the Chief Chamberlain said on entering.

"Request Chief Rabbi Lowe for an audience immediately!" the Emperor called, and the puzzled Chamberlain withdrew.

As soon as the Maharal entered, the Emperor, who had never seen the Rabbi before, recognized him as the old Jew he had seen in his dream.

"In my dream last night, you did not recognize me," the Emperor said reproachfully.

"You had changed, Sire," the Maharal answered.

"Tell me more about my dream."

"You went to bed with unkind thoughts last night. What did you have under your pillow?" The Emperor now remembered that the empress had placed the decree under his pillow, to be ready for his signature first thing in the morning.

"I promise you that no harm will befall the Jews of Prague," Emperor Rudolph said, and immediately tore up the papers containing the cruel decree.

"You spared my brethren much suffering," the Maharal said, "but you have spared yourself even greater pain."

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PARSHA QUESTION By: Gavriel Grodko

Who were the two men put in charge of building the Mishkan?

Stay tuned for the answer in the next Community Corner issue

Answer to last weeks parsha question:
Q. What was placed inside the Choshen?
A. The Urim VeTumim.

NOACH'S JOKES & RIDDLES By: Noach Isaacs



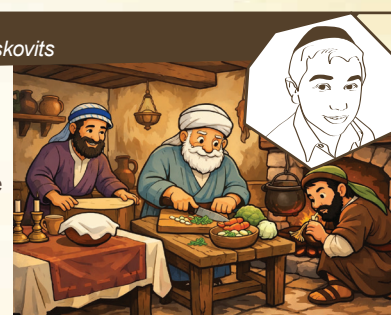
Why did the queen go to the dentist?

ANSWER: TO GET HER TOOTH CROWNED

B'KITZUR By: Daniel Moskovits

Preparing for Shabbos

There is a Mitzva for everybody, even a very rich person, who has servants and attendants who do everything for him, to do at least one thing to prepare for Shabbos, so that he himself honors Shabbos. *Short Halacha from this week's Kitzur Shulchan Aruch Yomi - Chapter 72 Se'if 5*



MEGA VORT By: Yoel Megadesh



Parshas Ki Sisa. Perek 34. Pasuk 28.

Moshe tells Bnei Yisroel that he did not eat or drink for 40 days while he was in the heavens getting the Torah. The gemara (Bava Metzia 86b) learns from this that a person should not change from the custom of the area he is in. On a simple level this means that just like in the heavens there is no eating or drinking, so too Moshe did not eat or drink while he was in the heavens.

The problem is that there is no food or drink in the heavens, so Moshe could not eat or drink even if he wanted to. So what is the proof that a person should not change from the local custom? The answer is that the proof is from the fact that Moshe ate and drank when he came back to THIS world. You see, Moshe became so purified in the heavens that he no longer really needed to eat or drink. But he still ate and drank in THIS world to show that you should not change from the local custom. (Kotzker)

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